

November 22, 2025

Jeff Caldwell				
Cincinnati				
Wide Receiver				
Height: 6050	Weight: 210	Year: 4SR	Jersey #: 9	Hometown: Louisville, KY
Games Reviewed: 2025 Iowa State, Baylor, Utah, Arizona				
2025 Stats:				
Career Stats:				
Scouting Report by: Danny Nolan				

Critical Factors					
Hands		Separation		Run After Catch	
5		4		6	
Positional Factors					
Release	Route Running	Route Savvy	Play Speed	Contested Catch	Playmaker
4	4	5	6	4	5
Tracking	Body Control	Clutch Performance		Blocking	Toughness
4	4	5		5	5

Strengths

- Acceleration
- Run after catch
- IQ as a route runner

Weaknesses

- Footwork and body control
- Maintaining initial separation
- Release off the line of scrimmage

Overall

Jeff Caldwell is a tall, lanky receiver who primarily lines up outside for the Cincinnati Bearcats. Prior to 2025, Caldwell spent three seasons at Lindenwood University, appearing in 28 games. This season, he has played in 10 games, starting 8 of them. Caldwell's physical makeup sports tons of potential, as he pairs his 6'5" frame with plus speed. He isn't the most agile in his movements, but his measurables alone make him a player opposing defenses highlight. He has an inconsistent motor and will pair some tenacious blocks with half-hearted attempts.

Pass Game

In the pass game, Caldwell's size makes him a mismatch waiting to happen for any defensive back. However, other areas of his game are not refined enough for him to fully capitalize on that advantage. He struggles to create separation, an issue that stems from an inconsistent release off the line of scrimmage. His footwork on in-breaking routes is sloppy, giving an alert defender time to react. Caldwell's best tool is his acceleration. His long strides enable him to break away from a defender for a few yards. He reads his matchup well and knows when to kick into another gear. If a cornerback's eyes are in the backfield too long, Caldwell might be gone by the time he looks back. He is most dangerous on routes where his cut doesn't need to be a hard 90°, such as slants and posts. Although he possesses game-breaking acceleration, he lacks the long speed to maintain that edge over a DB. He is good with the ball in his hands and can break tackles with strength and elusiveness. He actively looks for opportunities to pick up additional yards instead of going to the ground or out of bounds. Caldwell's hands are sufficient, but he won't do anything extraordinary. For someone of his stature, his ability to reel in jump balls is disappointing. He is capable, but he doesn't turn a 50-50 ball into better odds.

Run Game

Caldwell is an average contributor in the run game. He will make the easy blocks most of the time but will be susceptible to a hard-charging safety. Though he won't net additional playing time because of his blocking prowess, coaches shouldn't be scared of running the ball in Caldwell's direction. Jet sweeps aren't really part of his game, and he certainly won't be lining up in the backfield. He usually gives a fine effort as a blocker, but he might mix in the occasional whiff or pancake.

Last Word

Caldwell projects as a vertical threat in the NFL who lines up almost exclusively outside. While a viable target on third down, he doesn't profile as a short-yardage guy with an affinity for moving the chains. With increased strength, Caldwell could be a solid special teamer. He hasn't been used on special teams as a Bearcat but will likely need to carve out a role there in order to stick on an NFL roster. With his long arms, teams could see if he has any juice on a punt block. He doesn't have the shiftiness to be a weapon as a return man.

One-Liner: Caldwell sports an enticing frame and adequate speed, but he needs to improve his route-running and body control to make an impact at the professional level.

Grade: 5.9 - Ceiling: 6.4 (20%) Floor: 5.5 (15%) Round: UDFA